

ASPIRE LEAVE POLICY FOR INDIA

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1 INTRODUCTION

The Aspire Leave Policy for India provides the necessary guidelines for the employees of Aspire Systems Entities (Aspirians) to work on planned leave and leave in case of urgent needs.

This policy is effective from September 2025.

2 LEAVE GUIDELINES

- All leave will be calculated from 1 January to 31 December.
- Leave is subject to availability against accruals each month and approval by the primary manager and co-manager, as applicable.
- Employees should intimate and apply for planned leave in the Leave Management System (LMS) at least a week prior to availing leave, to enable proper planning of work.
- Request for leave may be approved, denied or deferred by the primary manager on LMS, if specific requirements or critical deadlines need to be met or if adequate advance notice is not provided.
- Should the employee be recalled from leave due to work exigencies or for any other reasons, that part of leave, which had been approved but not availed, will be credited back to their leave account.
- This policy governs and is applicable to all India employees of Aspire Systems Entities (Aspirians). However, employees working at Client Location under Conditional Offer (CO) will be governed by “Aspire Client Location (CO)” Leave Policy.

3 LEAVE FOR FULL-TIME CONFIRMED EMPLOYEE OF ASPIRE

This section defines the leave eligibility for all full-time confirmed direct employees of Aspire Systems India. The following are the different categories of leave that are available:

3.1 Privileged Leave

- Privileged Leave (PL) is applicable for all full-time confirmed employees of Aspire.
- Privileged Leave is a combination of the following leave types:
 - Casual Leave
 - Sick Leave

3.2 Privileged Leave Accrual

- For all full-time confirmed regular employees of Aspire, PL will accrue at the rate of 2 days per month worked and 24 days per calendar year
- In case an employee is confirmed during the month, the PL starts accruing based on the confirmation date and this is applicable for Trainees with Probationary period:
 - If the confirmation date is on 1st of a month, 2 days of leave balance will be credited for that month.
 - If the confirmation date is on 16th of a month, 1 day of leave balance will be credited for that month.

3.3 Privilege Leave Accrual for Long Term Employees

As a part of rewarding Aspirians who have contributed higher number of years of service with the Organization, the PL will accrue as follows:

- For employees, who have completed five years but less than ten years at Aspire, the PL will accrue at the rate of 2.25 days per month worked.
- For employees, who have completed more than ten years at Aspire, the PL will accrue at the rate of 2.50 days per month worked.

The above changes will be effective from 1st Jan 2026 in the next calendar year.

3.4 Carry Forward

- Of the maximum PL accrued in a year, an employee can carry forward only 12 days to the next year. Anything in excess of 12 days and not utilized will automatically lapse and cannot be carried forward/



encashed. Leaves for a year are closed in the beginning of the next year.

The earned leave eligibility accrues at the rate of one day per month.

For e.g., if an employee has joined on 1st June and has 14 days of PLs accrued for that year (June – December), a maximum of 7 days of earned leaves for this period will be considered for either carry forward or encashment and the remaining 7 days will be lapsed if the employee has not consumed before December.

For instance, if an employee gets relieved by the end of September and has 18 days of PLs accrued for that year (January – September), a maximum of 9 days only will be considered for encashment and the remaining 9 days will be lapsed if the employee has not consumed before the exit.

- In case an employee's carry forward balance accumulates beyond 12 days, the additional eligible PL will be encashed in the beginning of the next year after appropriate tax deductions.

3.5 Marriage Leave

- Marriage leave can be availed by all full-time confirmed employees of Aspire Systems Entities (Aspirians)
- Marriage leave entitlement will be 5 working days.
- The eligibility must be added by the Primary Manager and leave should be applied in the system before the date of marriage.

3.6 Maternity Leave

- Maternity leave can be availed by all full-time confirmed women employees of Aspire Systems Entities (Aspirians).
- Subject to the provisions of the Maternity Benefit Act, 1961, female Aspirians should have worked for a minimum period of 80 days to avail this benefit.
- The Organization provides paid Maternity Leave as per the statute for a period of 26 weeks (182 calendar days) of which not more than 8 weeks shall precede the date of expected delivery. This includes weekly off Saturday and Sunday and all public holidays.



- This benefit is applicable for the first 2 children during their tenure at Aspire.
- For the third pregnancy or subsequent pregnancies thereon, mothers are eligible for only 12 weeks of paid maternity leave to the woman employee during such maternity leave period.
- All women employees have to utilize their existing available leave balance before applying the maternity leaves in the system.
- In case of miscarriage, or medical termination of pregnancy (MTP), a woman employee shall, on production of such proof as may be prescribed, be entitled to leave with full pay under maternity benefit, for a period of 6 weeks immediately following the day of her miscarriage or, as the case may be, their medical termination of pregnancy. The employee is requested to reach out to HR Partner for the leave entitlement.
- At the end of the maternity leave, the Aspirian can extend leave for a further duration of 3 Months on a Loss of Pay and this can be availed with approval from the respective Manager and HR.
- The eligibility must be added by the Primary Manager and leave should be applied in the system before they go on Maternity Leave.

3.7 Paternity Leave

Paternity Leave can be availed by all full-time male employees of Aspire Systems Entities (Aspirians) whose spouse is expecting a child.

- The organization allows for a paid paternity leave of 5 working days.
- Paternity Leave can be availed 15 days before or within 45 days from the date of delivery of child.
- This leave can be availed at a stretch or in two parts (combination of which can be decided by the Aspirian) within 45 days of birth of the child.
- If Paternity leave is not availed within this period, it shall be treated as lapsed.
- The eligibility must be added by the Primary Manager and leave should be applied in the system before they avail the Paternity Leave.



4 ADOPTION LEAVE

To be entitled for adoption leave, an employee should have worked for a minimum period of 6 months in the Aspire Systems Entities (Aspirians). Below are the guidelines for leave entitlement:

Years of the Baby/Kid	Adopting Mother/Single Parent	Adopting Father
Up to 1 year	26 Weeks	5 Days
Between 1 - 3 years	12 Weeks	5 Days
Between 3 - 5 Years	6 Weeks	5 Days
Between 5 - 8 Years	4 Weeks	5 Days

- Adoption Leave should be planned well in advance, i.e., at least 4 weeks before availing the same and has to be intimated to the respective Manager and should have been discussed with the HR Partner for the addition of leaves.
- The eligibility must be added by the Primary Manager and leave should be applied in the system before they avail this Leave.
- An employee who avails adoption leave should submit supporting documents to the respective HR Partner.
- Adoption leave may be availed only after the actual adoption, i.e., when the child/children legally reside with the adopted parents.
- It is mandatory to submit a legal adoption certificate. If this legal certificate is awaited from the court, it can be shared with the HR Partner at a later date when obtained. In the interim, the employee may avail this leave type by submitting the letter from the Adoption agency stating that the child is under pre-adoption foster care.

5 BEREAVEMENT LEAVE



- Employees are allowed up to 3 days of Bereavement leave during the year in the event of the death of a family or immediate family member.
- Family/immediate family refers to an employees' spouse, child (biological or adopted), siblings, parents of self and spouse.
- Employee can discuss with the HR Partner and the eligibility must be added to the LMS by the Primary Manager. Bereavement Leave has to be availed within a period of 15 days from the incident, beyond which the eligibility of leave will lapse.

6 COMPENSATORY LEAVE

Compensatory leave is one, which is taken in lieu of any extra productive days spent by an employee on account of specific Client/Project Leader/Project Manager/Functional Manager request. Such extra billed time spent should be known and approved by the client for billability or other equivalent day off.

- Compensatory leave can be availed by all full-time employees of Aspire Systems Entities (Aspirians) including employees who are in their training or probationary period.
- Comp-off eligibility should precede the comp-off leave. They can be taken with the consent of the Project Leader/Project Manager/Functional Head and can be availed only if extra productive days had been spent earlier.
- Comp-offs will be available for 90 days from the date of accrual.
- Any unutilized comp-off will expire after this time and cannot be utilized after expiry.

Examples of days that can be counted as comp-off:

- A project in which there is a need for a sudden issue fix due to no fault of Aspire or delivery which the client has approved and requires resources to spend an additional workday on the project/task. This detail needs to be exchanged with the client and the client should consent to the additional billability or provide another equivalent day off.
- If a client wants to finish a particular release on a specified date, they may require resources to work on all Saturdays/Sundays in a particular month. The respective Project Leader/Project Manager then talks to the client and gets an agreement on the appropriate number of compensatory leaves that need to be provided to the employees for having



worked on a regular holiday and also agree on the dates on which such leave will be taken.

Examples of days that cannot be counted as comp-off:

- If an employee spends additional hours on the weekend to complete the regular work for the day/week or handle normal job responsibilities, the same does not qualify for comp-off.
- Any time spent by the employee towards his/her own development/learning/training after office hours, entertainment times and idle times does not qualify for comp-off.
- If an employee spends an additional day on a weekend towards recruitment activities (such as conducting interviews) and is eligible for interview allowance (as per the interview allowance policy), then this additional workday does not qualify for a comp-off.

7 LEAVE FOR ASPIRE EMPLOYEE ON TRAINING/PROBATION

This section defines the leave eligibility for all full-time employees of Aspire Systems Entities (Aspirians) who are on training or probation.

- Employees who are serving their Training period are eligible for 3 days of Personal Leave during their training period.
- Employees will be eligible for 6 days of personal leave during their Probation period.
- Any excess leave availed will be calculated as Loss of Pay.
- Personal leave will lapse if not used by the end of the training/probationary period.

8 LEAVE FOR CONTRACT EMPLOYEES AND INTERNS

- Contractual employees are not eligible to avail leave. Any such leave will result in loss



of billing to their respective contracting firms.

- Paid interns are not eligible to avail leave. Any such leave will result in Loss of Pay.

9 PROCESS OF APPLICATION AND APPROVAL OF LEAVE

- The employee applying for any type of leave should do so in the Leave Management System (LMS) along with appropriate reasons for applying leave.
- The respective Primary Manager and Co-manager (if applicable) will approve/reject the leave request via LMS and a status email will be sent to the employee once a decision on the leave request has been updated in LMS.
- For special category of leaves, the HR Partner must be informed so that the eligibility is entered and then employee can apply against the leaves.

10 LEAVE DURING NOTICE PERIOD

- Employees serving the Notice Period post initiation of their resignation are advised to not avail leaves.
- If an employee takes leaves during the notice period, last working date will be extended corresponding to the number of leaves taken.
- Marriage/Paternity/Bereavement/Adoption/Comp off leaves cannot be availed during the notice period considering that the notice period is meant for transfer of responsibilities/ knowledge to the new incumbent.
- PL account will be closed and any unavailed PL that is eligible for encashment at the time of separation will be added with the employees full and final settlement.



11 LEAVE AND ATTENDANCE TRACKING MECHANISMS

Leave tracking is done using the Leave Management System (LMS). LMS provides the leave status of an employee at any given point in time. Attendance is tracked using the Timesheet.

- Timesheet is an important tool to measure productivity. All Aspirians belonging to Delivery and Functional teams are expected to capture their time spent under the appropriate headers. Failure to enter timesheet will result in leaves being marked for the individual. Timesheet is the primary source of attendance for Delivery and Functional teams and will be tracked regularly.
- The LMS automatically calculates accruals and the corresponding leave balances, and provides employees with access to view available leave balances and leave eligibility at any given point in time.

12 LEAVE ENCASHMENT GUIDELINES

- The leave encashment process happens at the end of the calendar year.
- Employees have the option to encash or carry forward based on the leaves eligible and also based on the earned leave guidelines.
- Leave encashment requests will be intimated to the Payroll team and will be credited by end of February every year after appropriate income tax deductions.
- If no response is received within the specified date, there will be a default carry forward of the maximum limit to the next year.
- For the purpose of leave encashment, only the 'Basic' component of the salary drawn in the current calendar year will be considered. Leave encashment attracts statutory deductions such as PF.



13 EFFECTING LOSS OF PAY

- Any leave taken over and above the defined guidelines will attract Loss of Pay (LOP).
- LOP will be reconciled and effected on a monthly basis if the leave taken is 5 days more than the eligible leave at that point in time, or at the end of the year if excess leave has been taken.
- LOP deductions will be on the monthly CTC.
- For any leave taken continuously for 5 days or more, LOP will be affected on the total number of days the employee was absent, inclusive of non-working days. However, if the leave taken continuously is less than 5 days, LOP will be affected for the number of working days for which the employee was absent.
- Employees are expected to observe due diligence in availing leave for ensuring smooth operation / activities.

14 EMPLOYEE RESPONSIBILITY

- Employees of Aspire must become fully aware of the policy and process guidelines.
- They must ensure they apply for leaves on the system for proper tracking of leave balance.
- Leave balances can be viewed on the Leave Management System.
- Employees working at Client Location under Conditional offer will be governed by “Aspire Client Location (CO)” Leave Policy.



15 MANAGER RESPONSIBILITY

- Ensuring each member of their team is aware of the policy and process guidelines.
- Ensuring their team fulfills the mandatory work hours.
- Adding the leave eligibility for the employees on time in the system.
- Ensuring that approvals are provided on time in the system.

16 HR PARTNER RESPONSIBILITY

- Facilitating the policy guidelines specific to employees and proactively notifying employees of any changes.
- Ensuring accurate and timely recoveries based on inputs received (in partnership with HR Operations and Payroll teams).



17 MODIFICATION HISTORY

Date	Author(s)	Modification History	Version
November 29, 2005	Gowri Subramanian, Kalpana Srinivasan	Initial policy preparation	0.1
December 08, 2005	Gowri Subramanian, Kalpana Srinivasan	Final review and baseline	1.0
December 12, 2006	Kalpana Srinivasan	Review	1.1
October 3, 2007	Kalpana Srinivasan	Policy enhancement	1.2
March 25, 2008	Dinesh Kumaran, Dhivya Swamidass	Updation of LMS details, com-off, encashments	1.3
April 1, 2008	Gowri Subramanian, Sunil JNV, Shankar Krishnamoorthy, Dinesh Kumaran, Dhivya Swamidass	Review, feedback incorporation, Policy enhancement	1.4
September 2, 2008	Dinesh Kumaran, Dhivya Swamidass	Work hours changed from 9AM - 6PM to 8.30AM to 5.30PM, Employees relocating to an overseas nation can choose to do the following with their unavailed earned leave: Encash it at the time of relocation Leave it open in the Indian leave account so that they can avail the same when they get relocated back to India	1.5
April 29, 2011	Dinesh Kumaran, Dhivya Swamidass	Privilege leave introduced (instead ifSL, CL and EL) in order to provide more flexibility in planning for and availing leave.	2.0
May 03, 2019	Karthick Bala	Reviewed and changed company logo	2.1
March 6, 2020	Dinesh Kumaran	No review comments and approved	2.1



Dec 31, 2020	Srividya Bhaskar	Edited the months in Maternity Leave	2.2
Dec 31, 2020	Dinesh Kumaran	No review comments and approved	2.2
Aug 20, 2021	Srividya Bhaskar	Reviewed and no changes are made	2.2
Jan 13, 2022	Srividya Bhaskar	Reviewed and no changes are made	2.2
August 04, 2022	Srividya Bhaskar	We moved from financial to calendar year. Carry forward leaves has been changed from 24 days to 12 days. updated the changes.	2.3
August 04, 2022	Dinesh Kumaran	Reviewed and approved	2.3
February 08, 2023	Srividya Bhaskar	Reviewed and changed to new word template format	2.4
December 14, 2023	Srividya Bhaskar	Rephrased 3.4 privileged leave accrual paragraph for better clarity	2.5
December 14, 2023	Dinesh Kumaran	Reviewed and approved	2.5
February 01, 2024	Srividya Bhaskar	Reviewed as part of annual document review and no changes found	2.5
October 01, 2024	Srividya Bhaskar	Reviewed and updated 3.6 with additional details about maternity leave policy for better clarity and it gives clear instruction to the employees to apply maternity leave	2.6
January 31, 2025	Srividya Bhaskar	Reviewed and no changes found	2.6
Sept 1, 2025	Srividya Bhaskar	Reviewed and updated	2.7

